IN-STORE OPERATIONS · RETAIL

Compliance-drop explanations take hours of manual reconciliation.

Each compliance incident requires reconciling three data domains and rebuilding the explanation before the review meeting.

WHAT THE ROLE IS DOING

- Pulling store compliance audits, store master attributes, and inventory snapshots into a fresh analysis for the affected category
- Reconciling current versus prior period compliance, then segmenting stores into inventory-driven, execution-driven, and store-fit buckets
- Building a ranked driver narrative and store action list before every regional compliance review

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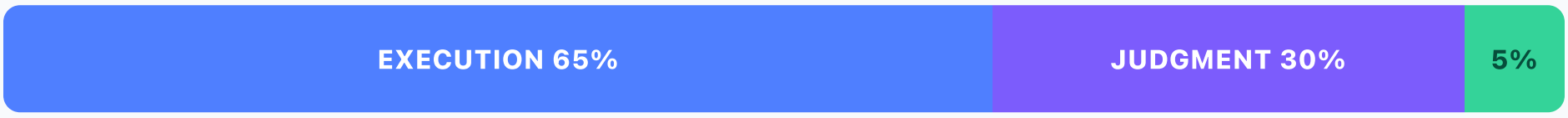
WHY THIS COSTS MORE THAN THE HOURS

That manual process makes the explanation inconsistent from one incident to the next and shifts the meeting into a debate over evidence quality. For this role, the result is slower approval of the right remediation path and more rework on store tasking.

Not all of this work requires your judgment.



- **EXECUTION 65%** The execution layer pulls audit, planogram, and inventory data, calculates compliance deltas, attributes likely drivers, ranks stores, and formats the brief and action list.
- **JUDGMENT 30%** The specialist still interprets edge cases, validates whether the recommended action fits store conditions, and explains the results to regional and store leaders.
- **STRATEGIC 5%** Management retains decisions about threshold policy, planogram design changes, labor allocation, and broader merchandising process changes.

The execution layer is what a Decision Intelligence workflow handles. The judgment and strategic layers remain yours.

What the workflow does — step by step.

1. **Find Drops**
   Compares current versus prior audit results to isolate stores with a material planogram compliance decline.

2. **Rank Drivers**
   Combines audit issue patterns with inventory conditions to classify the likely causes of the compliance drop.

3. **Action List**
   Builds a narrative brief and prioritized store action list with a recommended remediation for each affected store.

Each step queries the warehouse, executes business logic, and passes structured output to the next.

What this workflow does not do.

These decisions belong to the manager.

- It does not decide whether a regional manager should approve a full reset instead of a lighter remediation path, approve a local planogram exception for a store with fixture constraints, reprioritize labor across stores to execute the work, or determine whether recurring issues require a change to compliance policy or planogram design standards.

The workflow's job is to get you into the meeting already holding a consistent, defensible analysis. What you do with it is yours.

What the output actually looks like.

WORKFLOW OUTPUT — SAMPLE RESPONSE

Region R-NE compliance deterioration is concentrated in 2 affected stores, with the largest specific deviations at S003 (-19.0 pts, 84.0% to 65.0%) and S001 (-14.0 pts, 86.0% to 72.0%).

1. **Inventory-driven noncompliance** — 42% — S001 shows a low_on_hand_ratio of 0.83 with 8 missing facings, indicating missing shelf execution is largely constrained by low available inventory.
2. **Execution drift** — 58% — S003 has the larger weighted drop at 19.0 points, with low_on_hand_ratio of 0.33 but 10 missing facings and 4 wrong placements, indicating shelf execution issues despite some stock availability.

> ► Prioritize S003 for TARGETED_REFACE_WITH_PHOTO and S001 for ESCALATE_REPLENISHMENT, then review whether the issue remains localized or merits district escalation after task completion.

Generated by the Decision Intelligence workflow against sample data.

Run your own value estimate for planogram compliance work — or talk to us about your merchandising operations team.

The Cognitive Labor Value Calculator models team size, fully loaded role cost, and how much of the recurring workflow is execution work that can be automated. It takes under two minutes to produce a planning-level estimate.

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